

Ἄρατος ὁ Σικυώνιος

Aratus of Sicyon and the Achaean League

eul_aid: jba

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

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Aratus of Sicyon was a prominent Greek statesman and general of the 3rd century BCE. Born in 271 BCE, he fled to Argos after his father's murder and later liberated Sicyon from the tyrant Nicocles in 251 BCE. He secured the city's entry into the Achaean League, becoming its leading strategos from 245 BCE until his death in 213 BCE.

His career was defined by opposition to Macedonian influence, exemplified by his capture of the fortress of Acrocorinth in 243 BCE, though he later formed a necessary alliance with Macedon against Sparta. Aratus was pivotal in transforming the Achaean League into the dominant Peloponnesian power.

His only known work is the lost **Memoirs**, a historical account covering the period from 251 to 213 BCE. This text served as the primary source for Polybius's history of the Achaean League and for Plutarch's **Life of Aratus**. Through these historians, his political and military strategies, which significantly shaped the Hellenistic geopolitical landscape, are preserved.

Works (1)

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